

Meem Sakinah — Overview

Meem Sakinah is the letter Meem (m) WITH sukoon (no vowel). When Meem Sakinah appears before another letter, one of 3 rules applies. All 3 are called 'Shafawi' (lip rules) because Meem originates from the lips.

3 Rules Summary

Rule	Trigger Letter	Name	What Happens
1	Ba only	Ikhfa Shafawi (Lip Concealment)	Lips touch lightly + 2-beat nasal
2	Meem	Idgham Shafawi (Lip Merging)	Two Meems merge with 2-beat nasal
3	All other letters	Izhar Shafawi (Lip Clarity)	Clear Meem — no nasal hold

Rule 1: Ikhfa Shafawi (Before Ba)

When Meem Sakinah is followed by Ba, the Meem is concealed with the lips touching lightly and a 2-beat nasal hold before releasing into the Ba.

- Example: Hum Bil-Akhirah → lips touch gently, hold nasal 2 beats, then Ba
- You will see the small Meem marked in the mushaf — same as Iqlab sign

Rule 2: Idgham Shafawi (Before Meem)

When Meem Sakinah is followed by another Meem, both Meems merge into one lengthened Meem with a 2-beat nasal (ghunnah).

- Example: Lahum Maa Yashaa'oon → lahum-maa (held nasal, elongated)
- You feel as if you're saying one long Meem with vibration through the nose

Rule 3: Izhar Shafawi (All Other Letters)

Before any letter that is NOT Ba or Meem, the Meem Sakinah is pronounced clearly with no nasal hold. Strong and distinct.

- Example: Amthaaluhum → clear Meem, no concealment
- This is the MOST COMMON case — most letters after Meem = Izhar Shafawi

Key Reminders

- ★ Meem before Ba — be careful not to fully pronounce the Meem. Light touch of lips + nasal.

- ★ Meem before Meem — one smooth extended Meem. Don't say m-m with a gap.
- ★ Meem before everything else — strong, clear Meem.
- ★ A common mistake: making ALL Meem Sakinah sounds nasal. Only do that before Ba and Meem.